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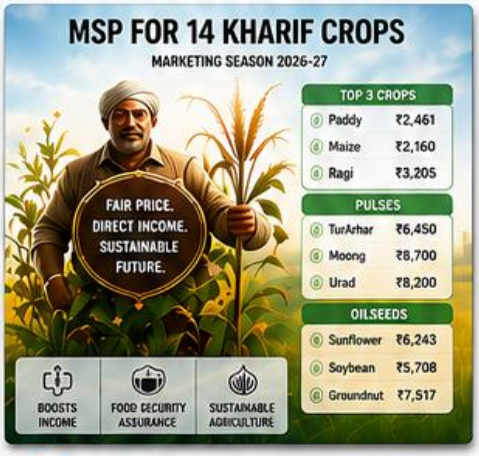


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Raw Information

2 LEARN FROM PICTURE



- Visual Learning
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3 DAILY CONTENT PDF



India assumes Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time; appoints Vivek Agrawal

In June 2025, India was elected as Vice-President of the Financial Task Force (FATF) for the first time. This reflects India's commitment to global standards in combating money laundering and terrorist financing.

Exam Hint:

- **What:** Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time
- **Who:** Vivek Agrawal
- **Body:** Financial Action Task Force (FATF)
- **Term:** July 2025 to June 2027
- **Significance:** Helps build trust and recognition.

PDF

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4 DAILY QUIZ



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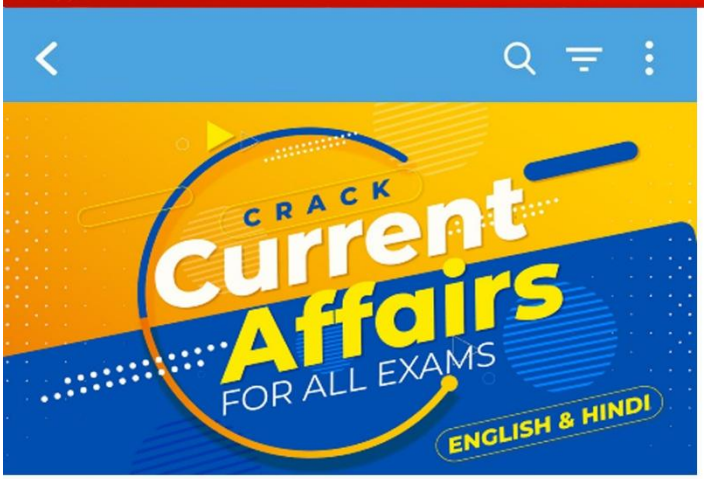
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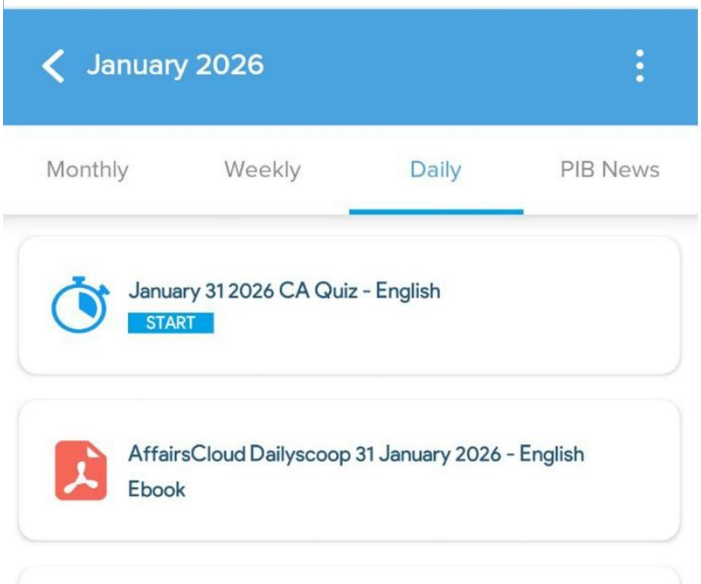
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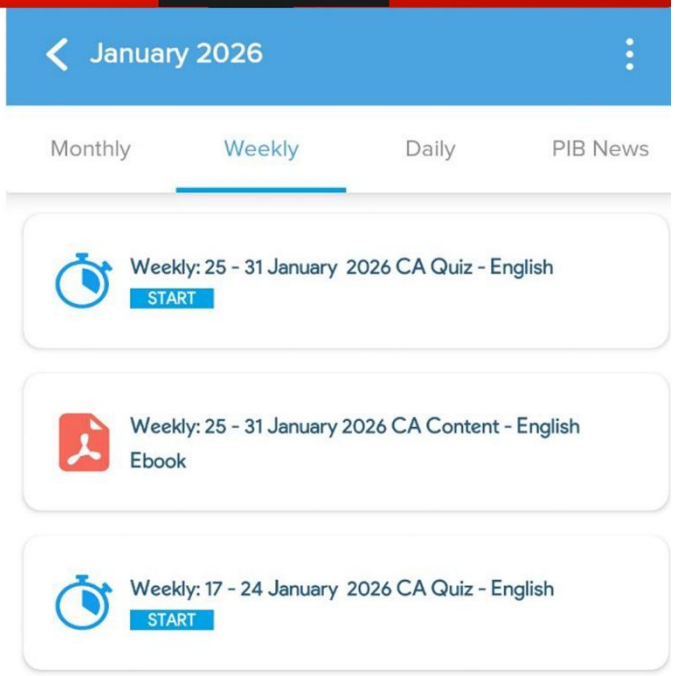
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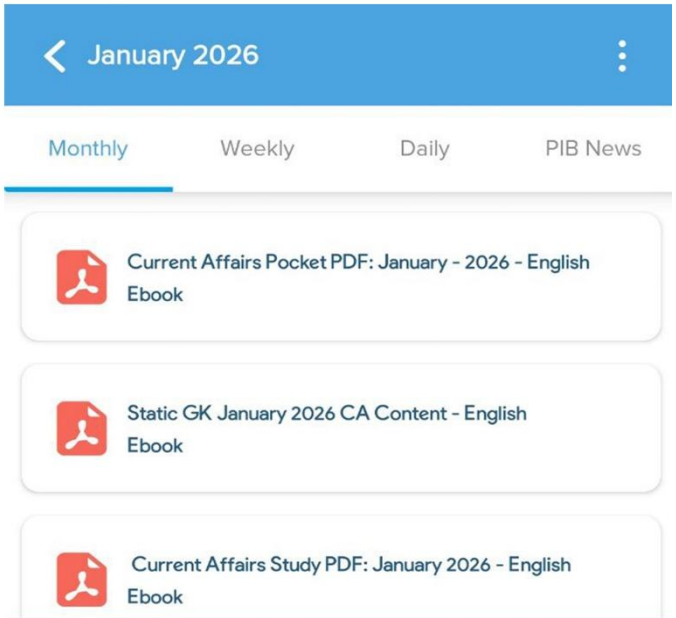
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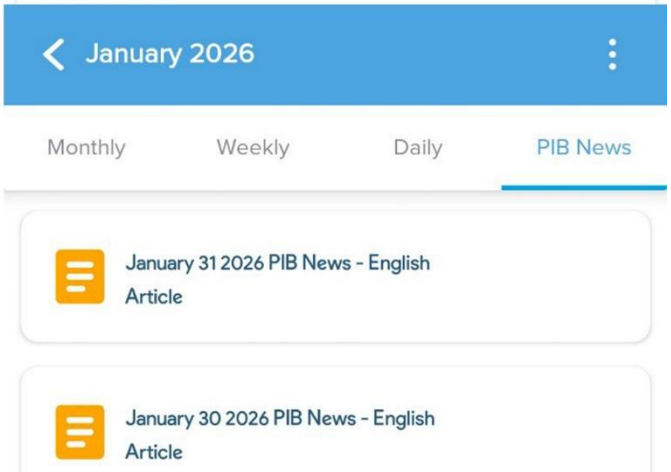
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HandWritten Notes

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NATIONAL AFFAIRS

1)

Jitan Ram Manjhi, Union Minister of MoMSME → Released → Rs.1,000 crore → As → Margin Money (MM) subsidy → Support → 11,333 new micro-enterprises

Margin Money (MM) subsidy → Under → Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP)

Launch: PMEGP was launched in August 2008 by merging PMRY and REGP to generate non-farm employment.

Implementation: Administered by MoMSME and implemented by KVIC.

Project Cost: Maximum limit – Rs.50 lakh (manufacturing) and Rs.20 lakh (service/business).

Subsidy: General – 15% urban, 25% rural; Special – 25% urban, 35% rural

Achievements: Since FY15, created 8.38 lakh+ enterprises and 75 lakh jobs, with subsidies exceeding Rs.25,193 crore

MoMSME – Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

PMRY – Prime Minister's Rozgar Yojana

REGP – Rural Employment Generation Programme

KVIC – Khadi and Village Industries Commission

2)

NSO, MoSPI → Released → 6th Quarterly Bulletin → Of → Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS)

- UR: Aged 15 & above – Overall – 5.1%; rural – 4.3%; urban – 6.8%.
- LFPR: 55.5% (Male: 77.3%; Female: 34.7%).
- WPR: 52.7% (Rural: 55.6%; Urban: 46.9%).
- Sample: 5,55,593 persons surveyed (Rural: 3,16,683; Urban: 2,38,910).

Launched in April 2017 & revamped in January 2025 for monthly & quarterly estimates

MoSPI – Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

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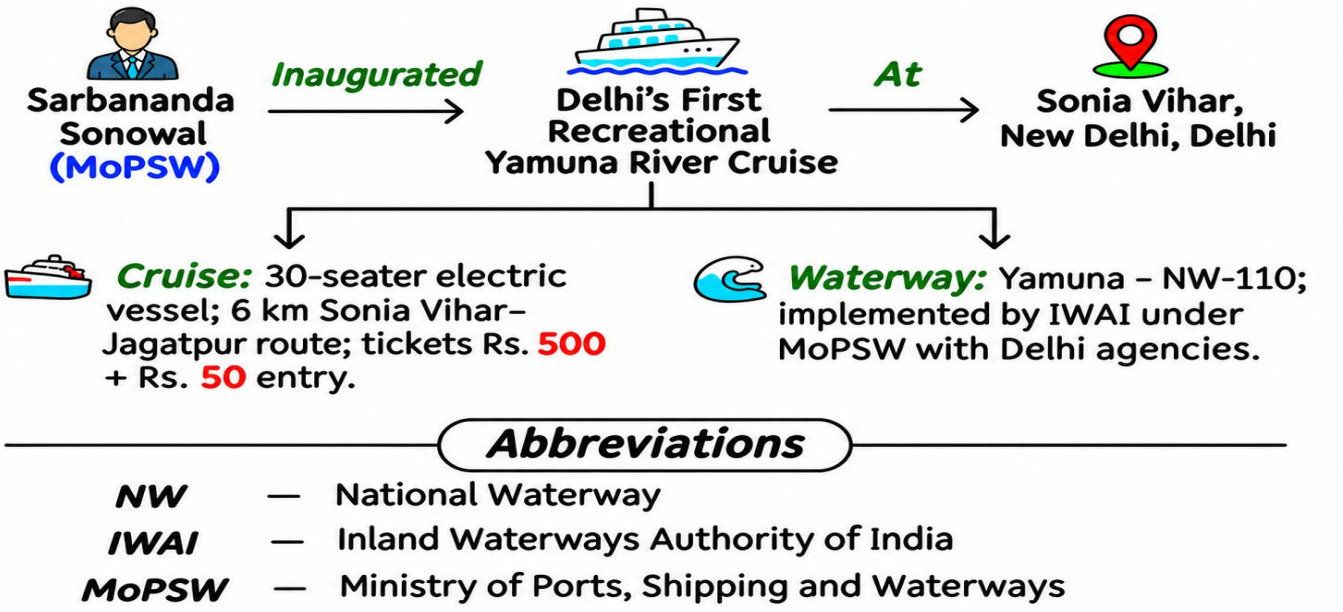
NSO – National Statistics Office

UR – Unemployment Rate

LFPR – Labour Force Participation Rate

WPR – Worker Population Ratio

3)



INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

1)



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BANKING & FINANCE

1)

RBI —Issued→ MD on Cyber Resilience and Digital Payment Security Controls for non-bank PSO —With→ 6-Hour Incident Reporting

- Compliance: Large/medium PSOs – immediate; small PSOs – 1 April 2028.
- Security: Board oversight, annual security audits and Cyber Crisis Management Plan.
- Cooling Period: 12 hours after registered mobile/email changes.

& Launched Three Key Surveys

RBI's Three Surveys:

- IESH: Price and Inflation expectations; 19 cities.
- UCCS: Urban consumer confidence in the economy, jobs, prices and spending.; 19 cities.
- RCCS: Rural/semi-urban Consumer confidence; 31 States/Uts, conducted by Ipsos Research.

RBI – Reserve Bank of India

PSO – Payment System Operator

CERT-In – Indian Computer Emergency Response Team

IESH – Inflation Expectations Survey of Households

UCCS – Urban Consumer Confidence Survey

RCCS – Rural Consumer Confidence Survey

UT – Union Territory

MD – Master Directions.

2)

IRDAI —Constituted→ 2 Working Groups —Under→ RBC Framework —Aligned With→ Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) —To→ Strengthen Insurers' Financial Stability & Policyholder Protection

- Life Insurance Group
  - Convener: Jamuna Choudhary
  - Members: 13
- Non-Life Insurance Group
  - Convener: Parmeshwar Shelke
  - Members: 12

IRDAI – Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India

RBC – Risk-Based Capital

3)

Patna Municipal Corporation —Becomes→ Bihar's First Civic Body —To List→ Municipal Bonds on NSE

- Bond Issue: Rs. 199.99 crore raised; bids exceeded Rs. 205 crore; 9.20% interest for 10 years.
- Utilisation: 18 projects across 15 Patna locations.

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NSE – National Stock Exchange

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

1)

M. John Harrison (British author) **Won** → **2026 Booker Prize** **For** → **The End of Everything** (13th novel)

- **Record:** At **81**, he became the oldest Booker Prize winner.
- **Prize:** Received **GBP 50,000** and the Booker trophy.
- **Novel:** Published by Serpent's Tail in 2026, the 198-page dystopian science fiction satire is set in post-apocalyptic Britain.
- **Award:** Received the trophy from David Szalay, the 2025 Booker Prize winner for Flesh.

Abbreviation

GBP – British Pound Sterling

2)

Lionel Messi **Becomes** → First Player **To Win** → Back-to-Back MLS Golden Boot Awards

- Goals (2026): Messi (26); Petar Musa (22), Sam Surridge (21).
- Awards: 2025 Golden Boot; 2024 and 2025 MLS MVP.
- FIFPRO: selected for 2026 Men's World 11; 18th selection.

MLS – Major League Soccer

MVP – Most Valuable Player

FIFPRO – Fédération Internationale des Associations de Footballeurs Professionnels

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

1)

ISRO **Conducted** → 200-second flight acceptance test **Of** → Cryogenic engine **At** → Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu

200-second flight acceptance test **For** → GSLV mission 'GSLV-F19'

- Mission: GSLV-F19 will launch Navigation Satellite (NVS-04) in 2027, strengthen India's NavIC system
- Test: ME and GG operated successfully.
- NVS-04: Fourth second-generation NVS satellite.

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ISRO – Indian Space Research Organisation
GSLV – Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle
NavIC – Navigation with Indian Constellation
ME – Main Engine
GG – Gas Generator

2)

China → Launched → CERES-2 Y3 rocket → From → Jiuquan Satellite Launch Center

- Satellites: Deployed 4 satellites into a 535-km Sun-Synchronous Orbit (SSO)
  - Payloads: Guanlan – Ocean sensing; Yunyao-1 28 – Meteorology; Zhongbei Daxue-1 – Scientific research; Juntian-1 06A – Space monitoring.
- Developer: Developed by Galactic Energy, a Chinese private space company.
- Configuration: Three solid-propellant stages and one hydrazine-powered liquid upper stage; liftoff mass of 100 tonnes.

SPORTS

1)

India → Secured → 5th Place → In → 47th World Armwrestling and 28th World Para Armwrestling Championships → Held in → New Delhi, Delhi

- India's medal Tally: 59 medals (9 Gold, 19 Silver, 31 Bronze).
- Top Nations: Russia (1st), Kazakhstan (2nd), Türkiye (3rd).
- Indian Winners: Jincymol Sebastian (2 Gold); Yogesh Choudhary and Shoukath V.T. (Gold and Bronze each); Madhura K.N. (Bronze).
- Next Edition: 2027 in Canada.

OBITUARY

1)

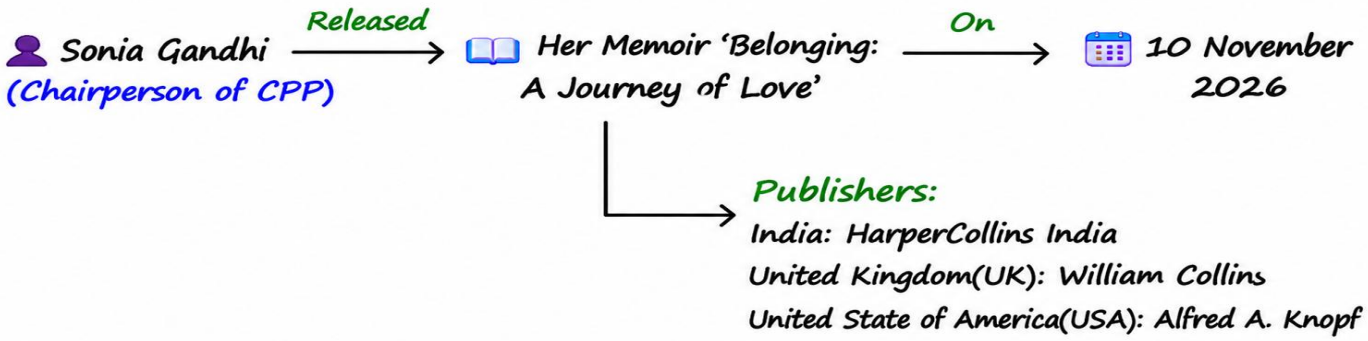
Pandit Manilal Nag → Sitar Maestro and Padma Shri awardee 2020 for Arts.

- Born West Bengal (WB)
- Passed away at 87
- Other Awards: Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (2001), Alauddin Purashkar (2012), Banga Bibhushan (2015).

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BOOKS & AUTHORS

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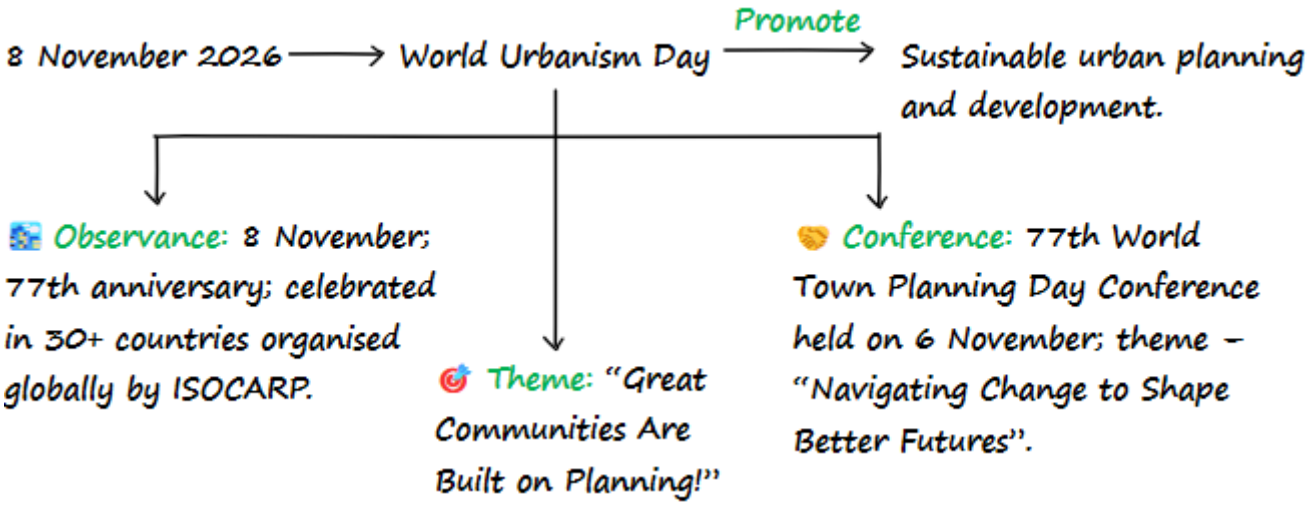


Abbreviations

CPP – Congress Parliamentary Party

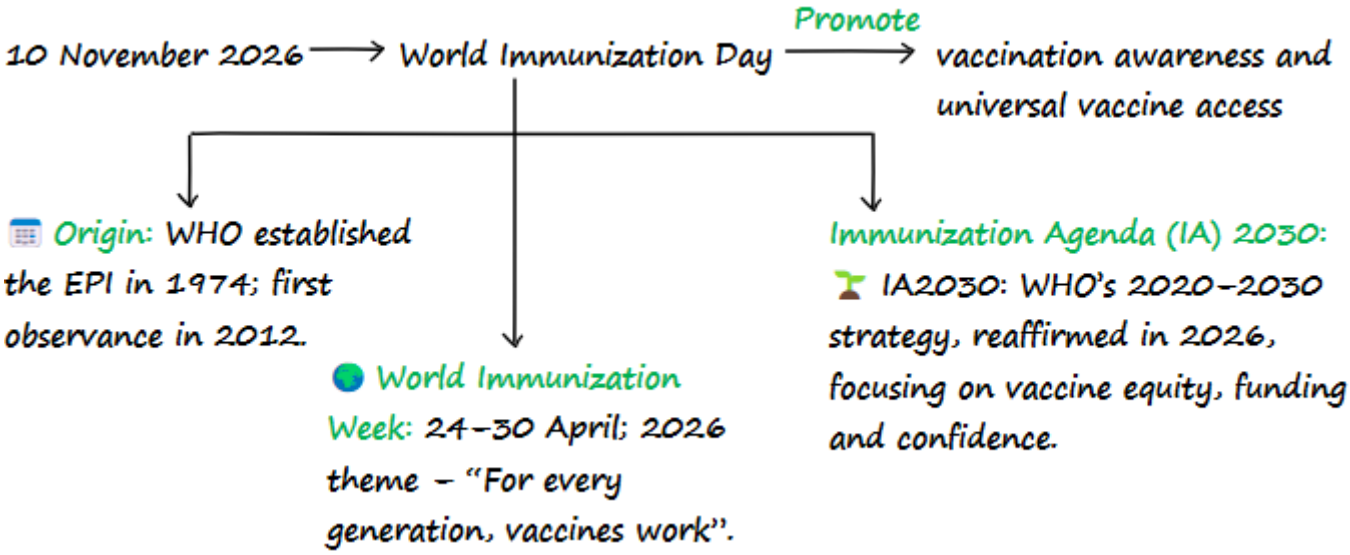
IMPORTANT DAYS

1)



ISOCARP – International Society of City and Regional Planners

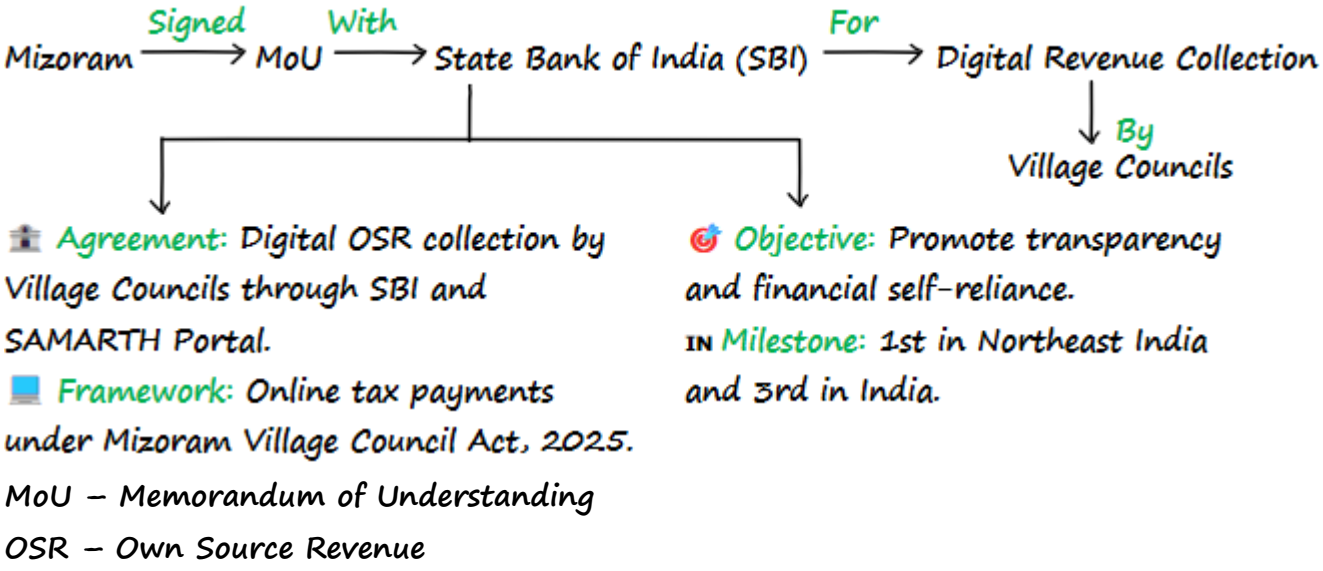
2)



WHO – World Health Organization
EPI – Expanded Programme on Immunization

STATE NEWS

1)



MoU – Memorandum of Understanding
OSR – Own Source Revenue

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Detailed Content

Current Affairs 12 November 2026: Headlines



- Union Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi Releases Rs 1,000 Crore PMEGP Subsidy to Support 11,333 Micro Enterprises
- MoSPI Releases PLFS Quarterly Bulletin for July–September 2026; Unemployment Rate Declines to 5.1%
- Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal Inaugurates Delhi's First Recreational Yamuna River Cruise Service
- Union Minister Kiren Rijiju Visits Saudi Arabia and Signs Haj-2027 Agreement; India's Pilgrim Quota Fixed at 1,75,025
- RBI Issues Cybersecurity Directions for Non-Bank PSOs with 6-Hour Incident Reporting, Launches Three Key Surveys
- IRDAI Constituted Two Working Groups to Prepare RBC Framework Aligned with Ind-AS
- Patna Municipal Corporation Becomes Bihar's First Civic Body to List Municipal Bonds on NSE,
- British Author M. John Harrison Wins 2026 Booker Prize for Novel 'The End of Everything'
- Lionel Messi Becomes First Player to Win Back-to-Back MLS Golden Boot Awards
- ISRO Successfully Conducts Flight Acceptance Test of Cryogenic Engine for GSLV-F19 Mission to Launch NVS-04
- China's CERES-2 Y3 Rocket Successfully Deploys Four Satellites into Sun-Synchronous Orbit
- World Armwrestling and Para Armwrestling Championships 2026: India Finishes 5th with 59 Medals
- Padma Shri Awardee and Sitar Maestro Pandit Manilal Nag Passed Away at 87
- Sonia Gandhi Released Memoir "Belonging: A Journey of Love"
- World Urbanism Day 2026 – November 8
- World Immunization Day 2026 – November 10
- Mizoram Government Signs MoU with SBI for Digital Revenue Collection by Village Councils

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NATIONAL AFFAIRS

Union Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi Releases Rs 1,000 Crore PMEGP Subsidy to Support 11,333 Micro Enterprises

In October 2026, **Union Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi,** Minister of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MoMSME), released **Rs.1,000 crore** as Margin Money **(MM) subsidy** under the Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme **(PMEGP)** to support 11,333 new micro enterprises across India.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Release of Margin Money subsidy under PMEGP
- ✓ **Who?** Union Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi, MoMSME
- ✓ **About PMEGP:**
- ✓ **Administered by:** MoMSME
- ✓ **Implemented by:** KVIC
- ✓ **Nature:** Central Sector Scheme; credit-linked subsidy programme.
- ✓ **Objective:** Employment generation through new micro-enterprises in the non-farm sector.

About Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP):

Launch: PMEGP is a major credit-linked subsidy programme and Central Sector Scheme introduced in **August 2008** to generate sustainable employment opportunities through the establishment of new micro-enterprises in the **non-farm sector** across **rural and urban** areas. **Merger of Earlier Schemes:** The programme was introduced by merging two erstwhile schemes, namely the Prime Minister's Rozgar Yojana **(PMRY)** and the Rural Employment Generation Programme **(REGP)**, which were in operation until 31 March 2008.



Administration and Implementation: PMEGP is administered by the MoMSME and implemented by the Khadi and Village Industries Commission **(KVIC)**, the national-level nodal agency.

Eligibility Criteria: Applicants must be above **18 years** of age. A minimum **Class VIII** qualification is required for projects costing above **Rs.10 lakh** in the manufacturing sector and **Rs.5 lakh** in the business/service sector.

Implementation Mechanism:

Subsidy Disbursement: The **KVIC** acts as the national-level nodal agency, implementing PMEGP through State KVIC Directorates, State KVIBs, District Industries Centres (DICs), Coir Board and participating banks. The **MM Subsidy** is routed through KVIC to participating banks and adjusted against beneficiaries' loan accounts as per scheme guidelines.

Financial Assistance under PMEGP:

Project Cost: PMEGP provides credit-linked financial assistance for establishing new micro-enterprises, with a maximum admissible project cost of **Rs.50 lakh** for the **manufacturing sector** and **Rs.20 lakh** for the **business/service sector.**

- **General Category:** 15% subsidy (Urban), 25% (Rural); beneficiary contribution: 10%.
- **Special Category:** 25% subsidy (Urban), 35% (Rural); beneficiary contribution: 5%.
- **Special Categories:** SCs, STs, OBCs, minorities, women, ex-servicemen, transgender persons, differently abled persons and beneficiaries from the North-Eastern Region **(NER)**, Aspirational Districts, and notified hill and border areas.

Achievements under PMEGP:

Since Financial Year 2014–15 (FY15): Established over **8.38 lakh** micro-enterprises, generated

approximately **75 lakh jobs**, with bank loans exceeding Rs.70,000 crore and MM Subsidy exceeding Rs.25,193 crore. Nearly **80%** of enterprises are rural, **50%** of beneficiaries belong to SC/ST/OBC categories and **40%** are women-owned.

FY27 (up to October 2026): Supported **25,895** micro-enterprises with an MM Subsidy of Rs.794.52 crore, as recorded before the latest Rs.1,000 crore subsidy release.

About Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC):

It is a statutory body established under the **KVIC Act, 1956**, functioning under the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MoMSME), Government of India (GoI).

Chairman – Manoj Goel

Headquarters – Mumbai, Maharashtra

Established – 1957

MoSPI Releases PLFS Quarterly Bulletin for July–September 2026; Unemployment Rate Declines to 5.1%

In November 2026, the National Statistics Office (**NSO**), Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (**MoSPI**) released the Quarterly Bulletin of the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) for July-September 2026.

- The Unemployment Rate (UR) for persons aged 15 years and above improved to **5.1%** in the July-September 2026 quarter, compared with 5.4% in the previous quarter.

Exam Hints

- ✓ **What?** NSO releases PLFS July-September 2026
- ✓ **LFPR:** 55.5%, Rural – 58.1%, Urban – 50.4%
- ✓ **WPR:** 52.7%, Rural – 55.6%, Urban – 46.9%
- ✓ **UR –** 5.1%, Rural – 4.3%, Urban – 6.8%
- ✓ **Rural employment shares:** Primary – 56.7%, Secondary – 21.9%, Tertiary – 21.4%.

Sample Data:

PLFS: It was launched in April 2017, PLFS assesses employment and unemployment trends in India. Revamped in January 2025 to provide monthly and quarterly rural–urban estimates, its July–September 2026 report marks the 6th quarterly bulletin.

- Key indicators include Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR), Worker Population Ratio (WPR) and Unemployment Rate (UR), measured using Current Weekly Status (CWS) based on the preceding seven days.

Sample Size: At the all-India level, the quarterly estimates are based on information collected from a total of **5,55,593** persons surveyed.

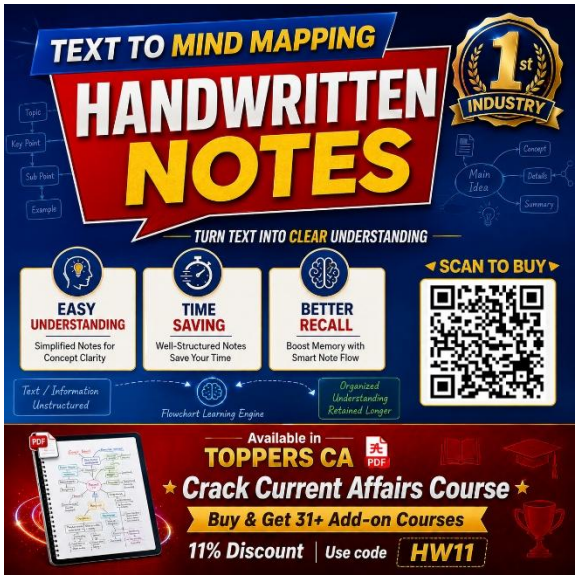
- 2,38,910 persons surveyed in urban area
- 3,16,683 persons surveyed in rural area

Employed Population: Using the projected population figures provided by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW), the absolute number of workers aged 15 years and above was estimated at an average of:

- **57.9 crore (Cr)** during July-September 2026, comprising 40.5 Cr males and 17.4 Cr females.

Key Findings:

Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR): The overall LFPR for persons of age 15 years and above



increased to **55.5%** in the quarter July-September, 2026 as compared to 54.6% observed in the previous quarter.

Rural LFPR: In rural areas, LFPR for persons of age 15 years and above rose to **58.1%** in the current quarter from 56.9% in the previous quarter.

Urban LFPR: Urban LFPR for persons of age 15 years and above increased marginally to **50.4%** in July-September, 2026.

Gender-wise LFPR: The overall male Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) increased to **77.3%** from 77.0%, while the female LFPR rose to **34.7%** from 33.2% in July–September 2026, compared to the previous quarter.

Worker Population Ratio (WPR) Findings:

WPR: Overall WPR for persons of age 15 years and above increased to **52.7%** during the quarter July-September, 2026 compared to 51.7% in the previous quarter.

Urban WPR: Urban WPR for persons of age 15 years and above was stable at **46.9%** in July-September, 2026 compared to 46.8% in April-June, 2026.

- In urban areas, the male WPR decreased marginally to **70.6%** in the current quarter from 70.7% in the previous quarter.
- The urban female WPR increased to **23.2%**, compared to 22.8% in the preceding quarter.

Rural WPR: Rural WPR for persons of age 15 years and above increased to **55.6%** in July-September, 2026 compared to 54.2% in April-June, 2026.

- The male WPR was estimated at **74.9%**, while the female WPR was estimated at **37.6%** in July-September, 2026.



Unemployment Rate (UR) Findings:

Urban Area: Overall UR in urban areas for persons of age 15 years and above remained broadly stable at **6.8%** during the present quarter compared to 6.7% in the previous quarter.

- **Female UR:** Female urban UR increased marginally to **8.8%** in the current quarter from 8.7% in the last quarter.

Rural Area: The rural area UR decreased significantly to **4.3%** in July-September 2026, from 4.8% the previous quarter.

- **Male:** The UR for rural male decreased to **4.4%** this quarter from 4.8% the previous quarter.

Sector Wise Growth:

Primary Sector: The share of workers engaged in agriculture increased from 52.9% to **56.7%** in rural areas.

Secondary Sector: The share of workers employed in the secondary sector declined from 24.4% to **21.9%** in rural areas.

Tertiary Sector: The share of workers engaged in the tertiary sector declined from 22.7% to **21.4%** in rural areas during July–September 2026 compared with the previous quarter.

About Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI): Minister of State (MoS) (Independent Charge, IC) – Rao Inderjit Singh (Constituency: Gurgaon, Haryana)

Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal Inaugurates Delhi's First Recreational Yamuna River Cruise Service

On 10 November 2026, Union Minister **Sarbananda Sonowal** (Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways **(MoPSW)**, inaugurated **Delhi's first recreational cruise service on the Yamuna River** at Sonia Vihar, New Delhi, Delhi, in the presence of Delhi Lieutenant Governor **(LG)** Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister (CM) Rekha Gupta.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Namo Yamuna River Cruise Service
- ✓ **Inaugurated by:** Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal (MoPSW)
- ✓ **Route:** Sonia Vihar–Jagatpur stretch; approximately 6 Km
- ✓ **Vessel:** 30-seater electric-powered cruise
- ✓ **Nodal Agency:** Inland Waterways Authority of India (IWAI)

About Yamuna River Cruise Service:

National Waterway Status: The Yamuna River is designated as National Waterway-110 **(NW-110)** under the National Waterways Act, **2016,** aims to boost tourism, navigation and inland water transport through the cruise initiative.

Route & Significance: The Cruise Service features a **30-seater** electric-powered vessel operating along the **Sonia Vihar–Jagatpur stretch**, covering approximately **6 kilometres** (Km) (round trip).

Significance & Ticket Price: Promotes sustainable tourism and inland water transport; cruise ticket costs Rs. 500 and entry ticket Rs. 50 per person.

Implementing Agencies: The project is led by the Inland Waterways Authority of India **(IWAI)** under the MoPSW, in collaboration with the Delhi Development Authority **(DDA)**, Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation **(DTTDC)**, Delhi Jal Board **(DJB)** and the Irrigation and Flood Control Department, Government of Delhi.

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

Union Minister Kiren Rijiju Visits Saudi Arabia and Signs Haj-2027 Agreement; India's Pilgrim Quota Fixed at 1,75,025

Union Minister **Kiren Rijiju**, Minister of Minority Affairs **(MoMA)** and Parliamentary Affairs **(MoPA)**, undertook an official visit to **Saudi Arabia**, from 6–9 November 2026, accompanied by the Joint Secretary (Haj), MoMA and Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Haj Committee of India.

- During the visit, **India and Saudi Arabia** signed the **Bilateral Haj Agreement-2027** in Jeddah, Saudi Arabia, confirming I**ndia's pilgrim quota at 1,75,025,** unchanged since 2025, and strengthening cooperation in Haj management and pilgrims' welfare.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Union Minister Kiren Rijiju's visit to Saudi Arabia
- ✓ **When?** 6–9 November 2026
- ✓ **Agreement signed:** Bilateral Haj Agreement 2027
- ✓ **Venue:** Jeddah Superdome, Jeddah, Saudi Arabia
- ✓ **Signatories:** Kiren Rijiju (MoMA & MoPA) and Dr. Tawfiq bin Fawzan Al-Rabiah (Ministry of Hajj and Umrah)
- ✓ **India's Haj-2027 Quota:** 1,75,025 pilgrims.

Key Highlights of the Visit:

Bilateral Meetings: Union Minister Kiren Rijiju held a bilateral meeting with Saudi Arabia's Minister of Hajj

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and Umrah, Dr. Tawfiq bin Fawzan Al-Rabiah, at the Jeddah Superdome to review Haj-2027 preparations, bilateral coordination and logistical arrangements for Indian pilgrims.

Conference: Rijiju attended the inaugural ceremony of the **6th Hajj Conference and Exhibition** in Jeddah and participated in the Ministerial Conference chaired by Dr. Al-Rabiah, appreciating Saudi Arabia's efforts towards pilgrims' welfare and reaffirming India's cooperation for Haj-2027.

Other Engagements: Rijiju interacted with Prince Saud bin Mishaal bin Abdulaziz Al Saud, Deputy Governor of the Makkah Region, attended the Noor-e-Diwali celebration at India House, Jeddah, appreciated the Indian diaspora's contribution to bilateral relations, and visited key Haj-related and cultural sites in Jeddah.

BANKING & FINANCE

RBI Issues Cybersecurity Directions for Non-Bank PSOs with 6-Hour Incident Reporting, Launches Three Key Surveys

In November 2026, the Reserve Bank of India (**RBI**) issued Master Directions (MD) on Cyber Resilience and Digital Payment Security Controls for non-bank Payment System Operators **(PSO),** tightening the cybersecurity protocols and mandating a strict **six-hour** incident reporting window for payment entities.

- The directions were issued under Section 10(2), read with Section 18, of the Payment and Settlement Systems (PSS) Act, 2007.
- The RBI announces the launch of three key surveys to capture inflation expectations and consumer confidence.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** RBI issues cybersecurity directions for non-bank PSOs and launches three surveys
- ✓ **Legal Basis:** Sections 10(2) and 18 of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007
- ✓ **Applicable To:** Authorised non-bank PSOs
- ✓ **Incident Reporting Deadline**: Within 6 hours of detection
- ✓ **Effective From:** 5 November 2026 for large and medium PSOs; 1 April 2028 for small PSOs
- ✓ **Cooling-off period:** Minimum 12 hours
- ✓ **Three Surveys Launched:** IESH, UCCS and RCCS
  - **Purpose of Surveys:** Provide inputs for RBI's monetary policy
  - **IESH & UCCS Coverage:** 19 cities each
  - **RCCS Coverage:** Rural and semi-urban areas across 31 States/UTs.

RBI Cybersecurity Framework for PSOs:

Effective From: The master directions take effect **immediately (November 5, 2026)** for large and medium non-bank PSOs, while small payment operators have been granted a compliance window extending until **April 1, 2028.**

Objective: The directions aim to improve safety and security of the payment systems operated by PSOs by providing a framework for overall information security preparedness with an emphasis on cyber resilience.

Reporting Time: PSOs must notify the RBI and the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (**CERT-In**) within **six hours** of detecting unusual incidents, including cyberattacks, critical system outages, internal frauds, or settlement delays

Responsibility: The board of each payment operator will be responsible for overseeing information security risks, including cyber risks and resilience.

- Boards may delegate primary oversight to a sub-committee, which must meet at least once every **quarter.**

Policy: PSOs must formulate a Board-approved Information Security Policy, review it annually, and prepare a separate **Cyber Crisis Management Plan** to address cyber threats and attacks.
Annual Audit Report: Authorised PSOs must file an annual System Audit Report (**SAR**):

- **By 1st June** – For entities which follow an April-March financial year
- **By 1st March –** For entities which follow Calendar Year

Corrective Actions: The SAR and compliance status must be placed before the entity's Board, with time-bound corrective actions, maximum **3 months** for open observations and progress reported to the RBI.
Cooling Off Period: Whenever there is a change in registered mobile number or email ID linked to the payment instrument there shall be a cooling period of minimum **12 hours** before allowing any payment transaction through online modes / channels.
PSO Classification: Large PSOs include the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), card networks, White Label ATM Operators (WLAOs), Payment Aggregators (PAs), Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) operators and large Prepaid Payment Instrument (PPI) issuers.

- Medium PSOs include medium PPI issuers and specified cross-border money transfer operators, while small PSOs cover small PPI issuers and instant money transfer operators.

RBI Announces Launch of Three Key Surveys:

In November 2026, the RBI announced the launch of **three key surveys** to capture inflation expectations of households and evaluate consumer confidence in the country.
Inflation Expectations Survey of Households (IESH): The survey aims at capturing subjective assessments on price movements and inflation, based on their individual consumption baskets.

- The study will be conducted across **19 cities** -Ahmedabad (Gujarat), Bengaluru (Karnataka), Bhopal (Madhya Pradesh), Bhubaneswar (Odisha), Chandigarh (Chandigarh), Chennai (Tamil Nadu, TN), Delhi (Delhi), Guwahati (Assam), Hyderabad (Telangana), Jaipur (Rajasthan), Jammu (Jammu & Kashmir, J&K), Kolkata (West Bengal, WB), Lucknow (Uttar Pradesh, UP), Mumbai (Maharashtra), Nagpur (Maharashtra), Patna (Bihar), Raipur (Chhattisgarh), Ranchi (Jharkhand) and Thiruvananthapuram (Kerala).
- The survey will be conducted by Hansa Research Group Private Limited.

Urban Consumer Confidence Survey (UCCS): This survey gathers qualitative responses from households on their assessment of the general economic situation, employment prospects, price levels, income and spending.

- This survey will also be conducted across the **same 19 cities.**
- The survey will be conducted by Hansa Research Group Private Limited.

Rural Consumer Confidence Survey (RCCS): This captures households' current perceptions and one-year-ahead expectations on the overall economic situation, employment conditions, price levels, income and spending.

- It will cover rural and semi-urban households across **31 states and Union Territories (UTs).**
- The survey will be conducted by Ipsos Research Private Limited.

IRDAI Constituted Two Working Groups to Prepare RBC Framework Aligned with Ind-AS

On 10 November 2026, the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (**IRDAI**) constituted **two working groups**, one each for life and non-life insurance, to develop a Risk-Based Capital (**RBC**) framework aligned with Indian Accounting Standards (**Ind AS)**.

- The initiative aims to transition India's insurance sector from the existing factor-based solvency regime to a risk-sensitive capital framework, ensuring financial stability and policyholder protection.

Exam Hints

✓ **What?** Constitution of Two Working Groups for RBC Framework

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- ✓ **Constituted By:** IRDAI
- ✓ **Number of Groups:** 2 (Life and Non-Life Insurance)
- ✓ **Life Group Convener:** Jamuna Choudhary
- ✓ **Non-Life Group Convener:** Parmeshwar Shelke
- ✓ **Framework:** Risk-Based Capital (RBC)
- ✓ **Aligned With:** Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS)
- ✓ **Deadline:** Within One Month
- ✓ **Key Deliverables:** Exposure Draft of RBC Regulations and Approach Paper

Working Group to Prepare New Framework

RBC Framework: IRDAI plans to introduce a Risk-Based Capital (RBC) framework in place of the existing factor-based solvency system.

- This approach will ensure that insurance companies maintain capital reserves in proportion to the risks associated with their operations.

Factor-Based Solvency System: In this system, capital requirements are calculated using pre-determined factors or percentages applied to an insurer's premiums, claims and liabilities, rather than fully considering its individual risk profile.

Ind AS: The proposed approach will use Ind AS statements as the basis for the RBC balance sheet.

Objective: The objective is to avoid maintaining two separate and disconnected systems for financial reporting and solvency assessment.

Composition of Working Groups:

Life Insurance Group: Convened by **Jamuna Choudhary**, the 13-member group includes chief financial officers (CFOs) or appointed actuaries from the Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), SBI Life, HDFC Life, ICICI Prudential Life, Bajaj Life, Tata AIA, Kotak Life, Bandhan Life and Aditya Birla Life, along with Munich Re and the Institute of Actuaries of India.

Non-Life Insurance Group: Convened by **Parmeshwar Shelke**, the 12-member group includes representatives from New India Assurance, ICICI Lombard, Bajaj General, SBI General, Tata AIG, Niva Bupa, IndusInd General and Kiwi General, along with Swiss Re and the Institute of Actuaries of India.

Areas of Examination: The working groups will examine various aspects of the proposed framework, including:

- Valuation of insurers' assets and liabilities.
- Determination of available capital and required capital.
- Classification of capital into different tiers.
- Identification and measurement of different risk categories.
- Calculation of capital requirements after considering risk aggregation and diversification benefits.
- Treatment of debt securities, expected credit losses (ECL), contractual service margin (CSM), reinsurance contracts and property valuation.

Key Deliverables: The groups will prepare an Exposure Draft of RBC Regulations and an Approach Paper, supported by data, quantified impact assessments and sensitivity testing.

Timeline: The two working groups have been given **one month** to complete their work and submit the required deliverables.

Legal Framework: The working groups will examine whether the converged valuation framework should be adopted for actuarial valuation under Sections 13 and 49 of the Insurance Act, 1938, alongside solvency-related requirements and supervisory intervention provisions.

About Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI):

IRDAI was constituted in 1999 and was incorporated as a statutory body in April, 2000. It also operates under the powers of the Insurance Act, 1938.

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Chairperson – Ajay Seth
Headquarters – Hyderabad, Telangana

Patna Municipal Corporation Becomes Bihar's First Civic Body to List Municipal Bonds on NSE

In November 2026, the Patna Municipal Corporation (**PMC**) became the first Urban local body in **Bihar** to raise funds through municipal bonds, mobilising around **Rs 199.99 Crore (Cr)** from the capital market.

Exam Hint:

- ✓ **What?** Bihar's first municipal bond listing on NSE
- ✓ **Issuer:** Patna Municipal Corporation
- ✓ **Amount Raised:** Rs 199.99 crore
- ✓ **Investor Bids:** Over Rs 205 crore
- ✓ **Annual Coupon Rate**: 9.20%
- ✓ **Bond Tenure**: 10 years
- ✓ **Purpose: Finance** 15 urban infrastructure projects in Patna.

About PMC's Municipal Bond Listing:

Bond Issue & Investor Response: The bonds were issued through private placement on 30 October 2026 via NSE's Electronic Bidding Platform (EBP), attracting bids worth over Rs 205 crore, more than twice the base issue size.

Interest & Tenure: The bonds carry an annual coupon rate of 9.20% with a tenure of 10 years.

Fund Utilization: The funds will be used to execute 18 development projects across 15 locations in Patna, including two vending zones, two marriage halls, one parking facility, one commercial complex, one hotel and one community centre.

Municipal Bonds: Municipal bonds are debt securities issued by Urban Local Bodies (ULBs), such as municipal corporations, to raise funds from investors for public infrastructure and civic development.

AWARDS & RECOGNITIONS

British Author M. John Harrison Wins 2026 Booker Prize for Novel 'The End of Everything'

On 9 November 2026, British author **M. John Harrison** won the 2026 Booker Prize for his **13th** novel, **The End of Everything** at a ceremony held at Old Billingsgate, London, United Kingdom (**UK**), becoming the first dedicated science fiction and speculative fiction author to win the prestigious award since its inception in **1969**.

- He received the Booker Prize trophy from **David Szalay**, the 2025 winner for his novel "Flesh."
- At **81**, he became the **oldest author** to win the Booker Prize, surpassing the previous record held by Canadian author **Margaret Atwood**, who was 79 when she jointly won the 2019 Booker Prize for 'The Testaments'.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** 2026 Booker Prize Awarded
- ✓ **Winner:** M. John Harrison, British author (81 year)
- ✓ **Winning Novel:** The End of Everything.
- ✓ **Distinction:** Oldest author to win the Booker Prize.
- ✓ **Prize Amount:** 50,000 GBP
- ✓ **Venue:** Old Billingsgate, London, United Kingdom.
- ✓ **Presenter:** David Szalay (Winner – Booker Prize 2025)
- ✓ **Judging Panel Chair:** Dame Mary Beard.

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About 2026 Booker Prize:

Prize Money: M. John Harrison received a cash prize of British Pound Sterling (GBP) 50,000 (USD 67,000) along with a trophy.

Judging Panel: The 2026 Booker Prize judging panel was chaired by Dame Mary Beard, a renowned classicist, historian and author and included Jarvis Cocker, Patricia Lockwood, Raymond Antrobus and Rebecca Liu.

2026 Booker Prize Shortlist:

- The End of Everything by M. John Harrison (British Novelist) – **Winner**
- The Disappearers by Marlon James (Jamaican Novelist)
- John of John by Douglas Stuart (Scottish- American Novelist)
- The Things We Never Say by Elizabeth Strout (American Novelist)
- Black Bag by Luke Kennard (British Novelist)
- May We Feed the King by Rebecca Perry (British Novelist)

About Novel 'The End of Everything':

Overview: Published in 2026 by **Serpent's Tail** (Profile Books), The End of Everything is a 198-page dystopian science fiction satire set in post-apocalyptic Britain, inspired by the 2008 global financial crisis, and marks the publisher's first Booker Prize win.

Themes: The novel explores societal collapse, uncertainty, and the growing influence of artificial intelligence and digital technology, reflecting contemporary anxieties surrounding the 2008 global financial crisis, Brexit, the Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19) pandemic, and technological advancements.

About M. John Harrison:

Profile: A renowned British author with a literary career spanning six decades, known for genre-defying fantasy and speculative fiction. He also served as an editor of the UK speculative fiction magazine New Worlds.

Notable Works: His major works include the Viriconium Sequence (1971–1984), Climbers (1989) and the Kefahuchi Tract Trilogy (2002-2012).

Previous Awards: Arthur C. Clarke Award (Nova Swing, 2007); Philip K. Dick Award (Nova Swing, 2007); Goldsmiths Prize (The Sunken Land Begins to Rise Again, 2020); Boardman Tasker Prize (Climbers, 1989)

About Booker Prize:

Background: Established in 1969 as the Booker–McConnell Prize, it was known as the Man Booker Prize from 2002 to 2019 under Man Group sponsorship and is currently supported by Crankstart.

Booker Prize Trophy: Officially named **'Iris'**, the gold-coloured Art Deco-style statuette was designed in 1969 by British-Polish artist Jan Pieńkowski and named in 2023 after novelist Iris Murdoch, who won the 1978 Booker Prize for The Sea, The Sea and was shortlisted six times.

Eligibility: Initially open to writers from the UK, Ireland and Commonwealth countries, the Booker Prize expanded its eligibility in 2014 to include authors of any nationality whose novels are published in the UK or Ireland.

First Winner: P. H. Newby received the inaugural Booker Prize in 1969 for his novel 'Something to Answer For'.

Lionel Messi Becomes First Player to Win Back-to-Back MLS Golden Boot Awards

In November 2026, Argentine footballer **Lionel Messi** became the first player in Major League Soccer **(MLS)** history to win the **Golden Boot** in consecutive seasons after scoring a league-high 26 goals for **Inter Miami CF Club**, United States of America **(USA)** during the 2026 regular season.

- FC Dallas' Petar Musa finished second with 22 goals, while Nashville SC's Sam Surridge secured third place with 21 goals.

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Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** First Player to Win Consecutive MLS Golden Boot Awards
- ✓ **Who**? Lionel Messi (Argentina)
- ✓ **Award:** 2026 MLS Golden Boot.
- ✓ **Club:** Inter Miami CF (United States).
- ✓ **Goals:** 26 goals in the 2026 regular season.
- ✓ **Assists:** 17 assists.

Highlights of the Recognition:

Previous Achievement: Messi won the MLS Golden Boot in 2025 with 29 goals and the Landon Donovan MLS Most Valuable Player (MVP) award in 2024 and 2025.

Performance: During the 2026 regular season, he provided 17 assists in 31 appearances with 29 Starts, recording a league-high **43 goal contributions.**

Standings: Inter Miami finished second in the Eastern Conference with 60 points and qualified for the playoffs, while Nashville SC set a new single-season record with **77 points**, surpassing Inter Miami's previous record of **74 points** in 2024.

Recognition: Messi became the first player in MLS history to win consecutive Golden Boot awards and the sixth player to win it twice. He was also selected for the 2026 Fédération Internationale des Associations de Footballeurs Professionnels (FIFPRO) Men's World 11 alongside Kylian Mbappé, Erling Haaland and Lamine Yamal.

- Messi secured his **18th FIFPRO Men's World 11 selection**, extending his record for the most appearances in the team.

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

ISRO Successfully Conducts Flight Acceptance Test of Cryogenic Engine for GSLV-F19 Mission to Launch NVS-04

In November 2026, the Indian Space Research Organisation **(ISRO)** successfully conducted a **200-second flight acceptance test** of the cryogenic engine for its next Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle (GSLV) mission '**GSLV-F19'**, at the ISRO Propulsion Complex in Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu (TN).

- The mission will launch the **navigation satellite 'NVS-04'** in **2027** as part of India's indigenous Navigation with Indian Constellation **(NavIC) system**.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Successful flight acceptance test of the cryogenic engine for GSLV-F19.
- ✓ **Conducted by:** ISRO
- ✓ **Test Location:** ISRO-IPRC, Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu.
- ✓ **Test Duration:** 200 seconds.
- ✓ **Engine Components:** ME and Gas Generator GG ignited as expected.
- ✓ **Upcoming Mission:** GSLV-F19.
- ✓ **Satellite:** NVS-04, the fourth navigation satellite in the second-generation NVS series.
- ✓ **Navigation System:** NavIC

About the Cryogenic Engine Test for GSLV-F19:

Performance: Both the Main Engine **(ME)** and Gas Generator **(GG)** ignited as expected, while the engine demonstrated normal steady-state operation during the test**,** with performance matching pre-test predictions.

Integration: Following the successful test, the cryogenic engine will be inducted into the cryogenic stage of the GSLV-F19 launch vehicle.

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Satellite: NVS-04 is the fourth navigation satellite in the second-generation NVS series, designed to strengthen India's regional satellite navigation capabilities.

Previous Mission:

- **Launch:** On 30 October 2026, ISRO launched the 2,250- kilograms (Kg) NVS-03 aboard GSLV-F18 from Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC), Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh (AP), placing it into a Geosynchronous Transfer Orbit (GTO) of 170.3 km × 38,080 km (kilometre).
- **Orbit:** After four orbit manoeuvres involving a 6,164-second Liquid Apogee Motor (LAM) burn, NVS-03 reached its intended geosynchronous orbit of 35,765 km × 36,196 km on 4 November 2026, strengthening India's NavIC constellation and restoring operational navigation services.

About NavIC:

Development: NavIC, formerly known as the Indian Regional Navigation Satellite System (IRNSS), is India's independent regional satellite navigation system developed by ISRO, originally designed with seven satellites comprising three in geostationary orbits and four in inclined geosynchronous orbits.

Coverage: NavIC provides Positioning, Navigation and Timing (PNT) services across India and up to **1,500 km** beyond its borders.

Services: It provides Standard Positioning Service (SPS) for civilian users and Restricted Service (RS) for strategic users.

Signals: Second-generation NVS satellites introduce the L1 frequency band alongside the existing L5 and S-band signals.

Applications: NavIC supports civilian and strategic requirements, including transportation, disaster management, fisheries, telecommunications, personal navigation and military operations.

About Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO):

Overview: It is India's national space agency and the principal research and development arm of the Department of Space (DoS).

Establishment: ISRO originated as the Indian National Committee for Space Research (INCOSPAR), established in 1962 on Vikram Sarabhai's recommendation, and was renamed ISRO in 1969 under the Department of Atomic Energy (DAE).

Arms: NewSpace India Limited (NSIL) is ISRO's primary commercial arm, while Antrix Corporation Limited is its first commercial and marketing arm.

Chairman – V Narayanan

Headquarters– Bengaluru, Karnataka

China's CERES-2 Y3 Rocket Successfully Deploys Four Satellites into Sun-Synchronous Orbit

In November 2026, **China** successfully launched the **CERES-2 Y3 carrier rocket**, developed by **Galactic Energy** (Beijing Galactic Energy Space Technology Co., Ltd.), from the Jiuquan Satellite Launch Center (JSLC), Gobi Desert, northwestern China.

- The rocket successfully deployed four satellites **Guanlan, Yunyao-1 28, Zhongbei Daxue-1 and Juntian-1 06A,** into a planned 535-kilometre (km) Sun-Synchronous Orbit (SSO) for commercial, scientific and space-monitoring applications.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Launch of CERES-2 Y3 carrier rocket
- ✓ **By whom?** China
- ✓ **Launch Centre:** Jiuquan Satellite Launch Center, northwest China.
- ✓ **Rocket Developer:** Galactic Energy (Beijing)
- ✓ **Payload: Four satellites:** Guanlan, Yunyao-1 28, Zhongbei Daxue-1 and Juntian-1 06A
- ✓ **Payload Capacity:** 1,600 kg to a 500-km low Earth orbit and 1,300 kg to a 500-km Sun-synchronous orbit.

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- ✓ **Significance**: First Successful CERES-2 Orbital Launch

About the launch of CERES-2 Y3:

Configuration: CERES-2 has three solid-propellant stages and a fourth liquid-fuelled upper stage using hydrazine propulsion, with an approximate **liftoff mass of 100 tonnes** and payload capacities of **1,600 kilogram (kg)** to a 5**00-km** Low Earth Orbit (LEO) and **1,300 kg** to a SSO at the same altitude.

Satellite Payloads: The four satellites have different applications:

- **Guanlan Shiyan:** Experimental remote sensing and Earth observation.
- **Yunyao-1 28:** Commercial meteorological observation and weather forecasting.
- **Zhongbei Daxue-1:** Scientific research and space-technology experiments.
- **Juntian-1 06A:** Earth observation and space-technology applications.

Orbit: SSO provides consistent lighting conditions for satellite observations, supporting ocean observation, environmental monitoring and Earth-observation activities.

Milestone: After its maiden flight failed on 17 January 2026, CERES-2 achieved its first successful orbital launch in November 2026, marking the 26th CERES-family flight and Galactic Energy's 27th orbital launch attempt.

Company Achievements: Galactic Energy has developed CERES-1, CERES-2 and Pallas-1 launch vehicles and reported deploying 94 commercial satellites.

About China:

President – Xi Jinping

Capital – Beijing

Currency – Renminbi (RMB)

SPORTS

World Armwrestling and Para Armwrestling Championships 2026: India Finishes 5th with 59 Medals

In November 2026, **India** secured **fifth** place in the **47th** World Armwrestling and **28th** World Para Armwrestling Championships, held in New Delhi, Delhi from 29 October to 6 November 2026, winning **59 medals** (9 Gold, 19 Silver and 31 Bronze).

- **Russia** secured 1st place, followed by **Kazakhstan** in 2nd place and **Türkiye** in 3rd place.
- The 2027 World Armwrestling Championship to be held in Canada.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** 2026 World Armwrestling and Para Armwrestling Championship.
- ✓ **Where?** The Leela Ambience Convention Hotel, East Delhi, New Delhi.
- ✓ **India Medals:** 59 medals: 9 Gold, 19 Silver and 31 Bronze.
- ✓ **Organiser:** PAFI, under the guidance of WAF
- ✓ **Top Three**: Russia (1st), Kazakhstan (2nd) and Türkiye (3rd)
- ✓ **India Performance:** India won 26 medals in the para category and finished 5th in the para standings
- ✓ **Next Host**: Canada.

About World Armwrestling and Para Armwrestling Championships 2026:

Overview: India hosted the World Championships for the first time, organised by the People's Armwrestling Federation of India (PAFI) under the World Armwrestling Federation (WAF), with over 1,700 athletes from 65 countries participating.

Medal Tally: The medal tally includes 26 medals in the Para category (2 gold, 10 silver and 14 bronze), 20 in the Sub-junior, Junior and Youth categories (3 gold, 8 silver and 9 bronze), 12 in the Masters and Grand Masters categories (4 gold, 1 silver and 7 bronze) and 1 bronze medal in the Senior category.

Notable Indian Medal Winners: Jincymol Sebastian won 2 Gold medals in the Grand Masters Women's 80 kilogram (kg) category (left and right arms), while **Yogesh Choudhary** and **Shoukath V.T.** secured 1 Gold and 1 Bronze each. **Madhura K.N.** won Bronze in the Senior Women's 70 kg Right Arm category, becoming India's only senior-category medallist.

OBITUARY

Padma Shri Awardee and Sitar Maestro Pandit Manilal Nag Passed Away at 87

On 9 November 2026, renowned Indian classical sitar maestro and Padma Shri awardee **Pandit Manilal Nag**, a distinguished exponent of the Bishnupur Gharana of Hindustani classical music, passed away at the age of 87 in Kolkata, West Bengal (WB). He was born on 16 August 1939 in Bankura, WB.

- He was honoured with **Padma Shri**, India's fourth-highest civilian award in the field of Art in 2020.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Demise of sitar maestro
- ✓ **Who?** Pandit Manilal Nag – Padma Shri awardee
- ✓ **Associated Gharana:** Bishnupur Gharana
- ✓ **Father and Guru:** Sangeetacharya Gokul Nag
- ✓ **Major Awards:** Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (2001) and Padma Shri (2020)
- ✓ **Musical Contribution:** Performed on AIR for nearly five decades.

About Pandit Manilal Nag:

Early Life: He received his initial sitar training from his father, Sangeetacharya Gokul Nag, a renowned exponent of the Bishnupur Gharana. He made his concert debut in 1954 and later emerged as one of the leading exponents of the Gharana.

Musical Career: He performed at several prestigious music festivals and contributed to the preservation of the Bishnupur Gharana through teaching and mentoring. He was associated with the **ITC Sangeet Research Academy, Kolkata** (2005–2011), as part of its Instrumental Music Division.

International Recognition: He toured the United States of America **(USA)** and Europe in 1973 under the Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) and represented India at the **Indian Ocean Art Festival**, Australia, in 1979, showcasing India's classical musical heritage internationally.

Contributions: Pandit Manilal Nag performed on All India Radio **(AIR)** for nearly five decades and mentored over **5,000** disciples worldwide, contributing to the preservation of the Bishnupur Gharana.

Awards & Recognitions: He received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (2001) for Hindustani Instrumental Music; Senior Fellowship (2005) from the Ministry of Culture; Honorary Gold Medal (2008) from the Asiatic Society, Kolkata; Alauddin Purashkar (2012) and Banga Bibhushan (2015) from the Government of WB.

BOOKS & AUTHORS

Sonia Gandhi Released Memoir "Belonging: A Journey of Love"

In November 2026, **Sonia Gandhi**, Chairperson of the Congress Parliamentary Party **(CPP)**, released her memoir **Belonging: A Journey of Love** on 10 November 2026. Published by **HarperCollins India**, the **544-page book** revisits her personal life, family experiences and major political events in India's history.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Release of Sonia Gandhi's memoir Belonging: A Journey of Love.

- ✓ **Author:** Sonia Gandhi, Chairperson of the Congress Parliamentary Party.
- ✓ **Release Date:** 10 November 2026.
- ✓ **Publisher:** HarperCollins India.
- ✓ **Length:** 544 pages.
- ✓ **Major Events Covered:** Emergency (1975), Operation Blue Star (1984), Babri Masjid demolition (1992) and Gujarat riots (2002).
- ✓ **Key Revelation:** Sonia Gandhi described the 1975 Emergency as a mistake.

Highlights of the Memoir Belonging: A Journey of Love:

Profile: Born on 9 December 1946 in Lusiana, Italy, Sonia Gandhi is the **former President** of the Indian National Congress (INC) and Chairperson of the Congress Parliamentary Party (CPP).

Emergency: She described the 1975 Emergency as a mistake opposed by Rajiv Gandhi and revisited Operation Blue Star, the Gujarat riots, the Shah Bano controversy and the Anna Hazare-led anti-corruption movement.

Babri: She described the Babri Masjid demolition on 6 December 1992 as a turning point in Indian politics and recalled breaking down in tears while watching the incident.

International publication: The memoir was published by William Collins in the United Kingdom (UK) and Alfred A. Knopf in the United States of America (USA). These are currently mentioned only in Exam Hints; add them to the main article.

Prime Ministership: She explained declining the PMs post in 2004 in favour of Manmohan Singh, citing his integrity. She also recalled Pranab Mukherjee's reported interest in the top post in 2010.

Personal Experiences: She recalled her medical treatment, Rajiv Gandhi's assassination (1991), the loss of her first child (1969), family tensions with Maneka Gandhi, discovering grenades after Operation Blue Star (1984) and Gujarat riots (2002).

IMPORTANT DAYS

World Urbanism Day 2026 – November 8

World Urbanism Day (**WUD**), also known as World Town Planning Day (**WTPD**), was observed across the globe on **8 November** to highlight the importance of urban and regional planning in developing sustainable, inclusive and liveable communities.

- 8 November 2026 marked the 77th anniversary of the observance, celebrated in more than 30 countries.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** WUD 2026
- ✓ **Observed?** 8 November
- ✓ **2026 Theme:** "Great Communities Are Built on Planning!"
- ✓ **Origin:** 1949, initiated by Professor Carlos María della Paolera.
- ✓ **Promoted by:** ISOCARP
- ✓ **Global Recognition:** GPN
- ✓ **Focus:** Promotes inclusive, sustainable and resilient urban and regional planning.

Theme:

2026 Theme: "Great Communities Are Built on Planning!"

Focus: Promotes collaborative, community-led planning to build inclusive, healthy, resilient and sustainable communities.

Background:

Origin: Initiated in **1949** by Professor Carlos María della Paolera of the University of Buenos Aires,

Argentina, to promote public and professional interest in urban and regional planning.
Promotion: The International Society of City and Regional Planners **(ISOCARP)** promotes the observance through activities organised by its members worldwide.

2026 Event:

Global Initiative: The Global Planners Network (GPN) highlighted the importance of collaboration between urban planners, governments and local communities in shaping better cities.
Key Focus: The 2026 campaign focused on affordable housing, climate resilience, social inclusion, public health and sustainable infrastructure.
International Conference: The American Planning Association (APA) and the Canadian Institute of Planners (CIP) jointly organised the 77th World Town Planning Day Online Conference on 6 November 2026.
Conference Theme: "Navigating Change to Shape Better Futures".

India's Contribution to Urban Planning:

- **Planning Institution:** The Institute of Town Planners, India **(ITPI)** was established in July 1951 and is headquartered in New Delhi, Delhi.
- **First Planned Modern City:** Chandigarh (Union Territory-UT), planned by French architect **Le Corbusier**, is recognised as **India's first planned** modern city after Independence.

Urban Development Schemes in India:

Urban Challenge Fund (UCF): Approved in February 2026 by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs **(MoHUA)**. It provides Rs.1 lakh crore in Central Government support to help mobilise Rs.4 lakh crore for urban infrastructure projects over five years.
AMRUT 2.0 (Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation): Aims to improve urban water supply and sewage systems, restore lakes and ponds, and promote rainwater harvesting.
Smart Cities Mission: By March 2026, completed 7,790 of 8,064 projects **(97%)**, covering improvements in roads, transport, public safety and basic city services.
Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana–Urban 2.0 (PMAY-U 2.0): Launched in September 2024, it aims to provide housing assistance to **1 crore urban poor and middle-class families** through house construction, affordable homes, rental housing and home-loan interest subsidies.

About International Society of City and Regional Planners (ISOCARP):

President – Elisabeth Belparie
Headquarters – The Hague, Netherlands
Established – 1965

World Immunization Day 2026 – November 10

World Immunization Day is observed annually across the world on **10 November** to promote vaccination awareness and supports the World Health Organization's (WHO) Immunization Agenda 2030 **(IA2030)** to ensure universal access to vaccines across all age groups.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** World Immunization Day 2026
- ✓ **When?** 10 November 2026
- ✓ **First Observance:** 10 November 2012
- ✓ **Objective:** Promote vaccination awareness and prevent infectious diseases
- ✓ **Global Framework:** Immunization Agenda 2030 (IA2030), 2021–2030
- ✓ **WHO Programme:** Expanded Programme on Immunization (EPI), launched in 1974
- ✓ **World Immunization Week:** 24–30 April, 2026.

Background:

Origin: The **WHO** established the Expanded Programme on Immunization **(EPI)** in 1974, following a World

Health Assembly initiative, to ensure that all children worldwide receive life-saving vaccines.
First Observance: The inaugural World Immunization Day was observed on **10 November 2012.**
World Immunization Week: Observed annually from 24–30 April under the leadership of the World Health Organization (WHO), the 2026 theme "For every generation, vaccines work" emphasised the importance of vaccination in protecting people of all ages from vaccine-preventable diseases.

About IA2030:

Global Strategy: Launched by the WHO in 2020 for implementation during **2021–2030** as a global strategy for vaccines and immunization.
Vision: To ensure that everyone, everywhere, at every age benefits fully from vaccines for better health and well-being.
Key Immunization Statistics: Vaccines have saved over 150 million lives since 1974 and protect against more than 30 life-threatening diseases, while 20 million children missed at least one vaccine dose globally in 2024.
2026 Development: At the **79th** World Health Assembly (May 2026), WHO Member States reaffirmed their commitment to **IA2030**, prioritising immunization equity, sustainable funding, vaccine confidence and stronger routine immunization programmes.

India's Immunization Initiatives:

Universal Immunisation Programme (UIP): Launched in 1985 to provide free vaccination against 12 vaccine-preventable diseases to children and pregnant women.
Mission Indradhanush: Launched in 2014, it aims to improve immunization coverage by reaching unvaccinated and partially vaccinated children and pregnant women.
National HPV Vaccination Campaign: Launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on 28 February 2026 to provide free, voluntary, single-dose **Human Papilloma virus** vaccination to approximately **1.2 crore girls** aged 14 years for cervical cancer prevention.

About World Health Organisation (WHO):

Director General **(DG)** – Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus
Headquarters – Geneva, Switzerland
Established – 1948

STATE NEWS

Mizoram Government Signs MoU with SBI for Digital Revenue Collection by Village Councils

On November 10 2026, the Government of **Mizoram** signed a Memorandum of Understanding (**MoU**) with the State Bank of India (**SBI**) to enable Village Councils to digitally collect Own Source Revenue (**OSR**) through the SAMARTH Panchayat Portal and payment gateway, strengthening grassroots governance and financial self-reliance.

- The MoU was signed by Lalngura Tlau, Director, Rural Development and Administration Department (RD&AD), and Manish Uppal, Deputy General Manager (DGM), SBI

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What:** MoU Signed
- ✓ **Entities:** Government of Mizoram and SBI
- ✓ **Signatories:** Lalngura Tlau (Mizoram) and Manish Uppal (SB)
- ✓ **Purpose:** Digital collection of OSR by Village Councils
- ✓ **Digital Platform:** SAMARTH portal and payment gateway
- ✓ **Significance:** Mizoram became the first state in Northeast India and third in India to sign agreement.

About Mizoram Government–SBI MoU:

Objective: The initiative promotes grassroots governance, digital governance, transparency and accountability, and rural development aligned with **Viksit Bharat 2047 vision.**

Framework: Under the Mizoram Village Council Act, 2025, residents can pay taxes and other revenues online through SBI's payment gateway, with transactions digitally recorded and monitored via the SAMARTH portal.

Significance: Strengthening OSR will enable Village Councils to achieve financial self-reliance, generate independent revenue and qualify for performance-based grants under the 16th Finance Commission.

Milestone: Mizoram became the **first** state in Northeast India and **third** state in India to sign an agreement with SBI for digital OSR collection through the SAMARTH portal.



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